DAY 15 | POST-READ

FDE Identity and Action: Recap and Beyond

What we practised today, plus ideas to keep developing.

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Part A: Summary of today

Topic	What to remember
FDE role	Embeds with customers, builds real solutions, translates between business and tech, feeds lessons back to the product.
Versus other roles	Engineers build for many; consultants advise; solutions engineers prove fit; FDEs deliver outcomes in production.
Ownership	Treat the customer's problem as yours until solved; follow up, find workarounds, close loops.
Customer focus	Success is the customer's outcome, not technical elegance.
Two-way doors	Reversible decisions: decide fast, learn, adjust.
One-way doors	Hard to reverse: slow down, consult, document.
Smallest useful step	Know, assume, act, learn. Test the biggest assumption first.
Status update	Situation, action, next (with date), ask.

Part B: Going beyond today

1. The assumptions log

Keep a simple running list: assumption, how confident you are, how you will test it, and the date you checked. Share it with the customer. It turns hidden guesses into visible, testable items and builds trust.

2. The decision log

For every meaningful decision, record the date, the decision, the options considered, why you chose this one, and who agreed. Weeks later, when someone asks "why did we do this?", you have the answer in seconds.

3. Timeboxing

Give exploration a fixed budget: "I will spend 45 minutes on this; if I am not closer, I will ask for help." Timeboxes protect you from both rushing and endless research.

4. Escalating well

Escalation is not failure. Escalate early, with facts, impact, options you considered and a recommendation. Leaders can act on that. They cannot act on "it is broken".

5. Feedback that helps

Use situation, behaviour, impact: "In the role play (situation), you summarised the customer's goal before proposing anything (behaviour), and they visibly relaxed (impact)."

Part C: Reflect

- Which of the six habits is your strongest today? Which needs the most practice?
- Describe one two-way door decision you delayed recently. What would acting faster have looked like?
- Rewrite your last work update using situation, action, next, ask.
- What did you learn from watching others in the role plays?

Part D: Practice ideas for the weekend

- Start an assumptions log for a project you are working on.
- Explain one technical concept from this course to a friend or family member in under two minutes.
- Pick one small task you have been postponing and do the smallest useful step today.

Coming up on Day 16: back to data: an end-to-end PySpark batch pipeline, a SQL refresher and Spark SQL.

Yoi shuumatsu wo (良い週末を): have a great weekend